Ford Ford Escort (Australia) Specification & Service Reference - Page 1/1

AUSTRALIAN AUTOMOTIVE ARCHIVE - TECHNICAL & SPECIFICATION DOSSIER

Make: Ford | Model: Ford Escort | Australian Market Years: 1970-1981

Vehicle Type: 2-door Coupe / 4-door Sedan / 2-door Panel Van | Segment: Small / Compact | Locally Built:

Assembly Plants (AU): Homebush, New South Wales

1. MODEL OVERVIEW & AUSTRALIAN MARKET NOTES

The Ford Escort was Ford Australia’s frontline small car and grassroots rally champion througho
ut the 1970s. Manufactured at Ford’s Homebush plant in Sydney, the Australian Mk1 (1970-1975) f
eatured the classic ’dogbone’ front grille, Kent Crossflow engines (1.1L, 1.3L, and 1.6L GT), a
nd the legendary imported Twin Cam and RS1600. In 1975, the Australian Mk2 debuted with a squar
er aerodynamic profile. Ford Australia equipped the Mk2 with the lively 1.6L Kent and the poten
t 2.0L OHC Pinto engine, culminating in the iconic Escort RS2000 featuring a polyurethane droop
-snoot front nose, four-spoke alloy wheels, Scheel sports bucket seats, and rally-bred handling
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Australian Escorts featured unique local content including Australian-made glass, batteries, in
terior trim, and heavy-duty front suspension struts tailored to corrugated rural backroads. The
Escort RS2000 was an instant youth idol, while the Escort Sundowner panel van tapped into the
1970s surf van craze with bold bodyside sunset decals and rear bubble port-hole windows.

SERIES / GENERATION: Mk1 (Mk1 Escort) [1970-1975]

Body Styles: 2-door coupe, 4-door sedan, 2-door panel van | ANCAP: None

Homebush, NSW manufacturing. Dogbone grille, round headlights, Kent Crossflow engines, and the
rare Twin Cam homologation specials.

Engines Offered in Australia:

- Kent-1.3L: 1.3L (1298cc) Inline4 (Naturally Aspirated, Petrol) | 43.0 kW / 95.0 Nm
- Kent-1.6L-GT: 1.6L (1599cc) Inline4 (Naturally Aspirated, Petrol) | 64.0 kW / 125.0 Nm

Australian Badges / Trims:

- Escort 1600 GT: Drivetrain=RWD, Trans=4-speed manual floor, AUD $2490-$2790, Fuel=8.8L/100km

Factory Configurations:

* Escort 1600 GT | 2-door coupe | Kent-1.6L-GT | 4-speed manual floor | RWD | 64.0kW/125.0Nm

SERIES / GENERATION: Mk2 (Mk2 Escort) [1975-1981]

Body Styles: 2-door coupe, 4-door sedan, 2-door panel van | ANCAP: None

Squared aerodynamic body, 2.0L Pinto OHC engine, Sundowner lifestyle panel van, and the iconic
Australian Escort RS2000 with polyurethane droop-snoot nose.

Engines Offered in Australia:

- Pinto-2.0L: 2.0L (1993cc) Inline4 (Naturally Aspirated, Petrol) | 70.0 kW / 152.0 Nm

Australian Badges / Trims:

- RS2000: Drivetrain=RWD, Trans=4-speed manual floor, AUD $5190-$6290, Fuel=9.5L/100km
- Sundowner Van: Drivetrain=RWD, Trans=4-speed manual floor, AUD $4490-$5150, Fuel=9.8L/100km

Factory Configurations:

* RS2000 | 2-door coupe | Pinto-2.0L | 4-speed manual floor | RWD | 70.0kW/152.0Nm